

METALLIC-CARTRIDGE REVOLVERS (1871–79)

With the production of robust and reliable metallic cartridges, gun manufacturers could develop and improve upon all kinds of pistols and other guns to use them effectively. Revolvers continued to improve and were made in considerable variety. Some, like Colt and Remington revolvers, had fixed cylinders loaded through a rear gate, while others had cylinders that swung out sideways, or, like those made by Smith and Wesson, had frames that hinged open.



◀ SMITH AND WESSON NO. 3 RUSSIAN MODEL

Date 1871
Origin US
Barrel 8in (20.3cm)
Caliber .44in S and W Russian

Smith and Wesson won a contract to supply the Russian Army with 20,000 units of its No 3 pistol, chambered for a special cartridge. These were the most accurate revolvers of their day.



▲ COLT SINGLE-ACTION ARMY (SAA) MODEL 1873

Date 1873
Origin US
Barrel 7½in (19cm)
Caliber .45in

The Colt SAA ("Peacemaker") (see p.95) married the single-action lock of the old Dragoon model to a bored-through cylinder in a solid frame, into which the barrel was screwed.



▲ DUTCH M1873 ARMY REVOLVER

Date 1873
Origin Netherlands
Barrel 6½in (16cm)
Caliber 9.4 × 21mm rim-fire

Two models of the M1873 were made for the Dutch Army. The earlier model had an octagonal barrel, while the later one had a round barrel.



▲ REMINGTON ARMY MODEL 1875

Date 1875
Origin US
Barrel 7½in (19cm)
Caliber .45in

This gun was similar in build to the Colt Single Action Army Model of 1873. It had a web beneath the barrel to help guide it while being stored in its holster. It was also adapted for .40in and .44in cartridges.



▲ COLT LIGHTNING DOUBLE ACTION

Date 1877
Origin US
Barrel 5½in (14cm)
Caliber .38in

The Lightning was Colt's first double-action handgun. It was a small-frame revolver chambered for .38in cartridges, although Colt also produced an accompanying weapon, the Thunderer, in .44in caliber to cater to those preferring a heavier punch. Although the Lightning had some quality issues, sales were still respectable, and the total production run reached 166,000 guns.